

FIND THE ERRORS

- *A caldera is formed when land collapses under a volcano after a gigantic eruption. A caldera looks like a soup bowl. In the United States, Yellowstone National Park is the most famous caldera. The Ngorongoro Crater is the world's largest unbroken volcanic caldera, its diameter is about 12 miles across. It is the home of many wildlife species, such as zebras, lions, elephants, and black rhinoceros.*

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FIND THE ERRORS

- *Dmitri Mendeleev. He was a famous Russian chemist. Because he created the periodic table of elements. Before Mendeleev's discovery, there were no common symbols and formulas for elements. For example, the chemical formula H₂O. It could mean water for one scientist and something completely different to another scientist. Mendeleev arranged different elements in an understandable manner.*

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- **Dmitri Mendeleev.** He was a famous Russian chemist. **Because he created the periodic table of elements.** Before Mendeleev's discovery, there were no common symbols and formulas for elements. **For example, the chemical formula H₂O.** It could mean water for one scientist and something completely different to another scientist. Mendeleev arranged different elements in an understandable manner.

RUN-ONS & FRAGMENTS

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Recognise the fragments and run-on sentences in academic writing.

Apply the methods to fix run-ons and fragments.



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RUN-ONS

- ❑ Two or more independent clauses joined incorrectly.

Fused Sentences

- A fused sentence occurs when independent clauses run together with **no marks of punctuation or coordinating conjunctions** to separate them.

Example:

- *The composite resin was placed correctly the bond strength was excellent.*

Comma Splice

- A comma splice occurs when two or more independent clauses are joined **only by a comma**.

Example:

- *The composite resin was placed correctly, the bond strength was excellent.*



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HOW TO FIX?

1. To join independent clauses, Use a comma and a coordinating conjunction (and, but, yet, so, or, nor, for).

■ Example:

Error: My professor read my paper she said it was excellent.

- *The composite resin was placed correctly, and the bond strength was excellent.*

2. Use a semicolon (;)

■ Examples:

- *The composite resin was placed correctly; the bond strength was excellent.*



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HOW TO FIX?

3. Separate the independent clauses into sentences. (Adding full stop)

Example:

- **Error:** *The composite resin was placed correctly the bond strength was excellent.*
- *The composite resin was placed correctly. The bond strength was excellent.*

4. Restructure the sentence by subordinating one of the clauses. (Adding subordinator)

- **Because** *the composite resin was placed correctly, the bond strength was excellent.*

SENTENCE FRAGMENT

- A sentence fragment is a group of words that lacks one or more of these three things (**Subject, verb, and a complete thought**). (More common in newspaper headlines and advertisements)

Fragments include:

- **Dependent clauses by themselves** (When the boy got home from school.).
- **Descriptive phrases that do not have subjects and/or verbs** (working hard to make good grades in the class.).
- **Clauses with only part of a verb phrase** (some of the athletes playing on the court.).

IF YOU THINK A SUBJECT IS MISSING, THE VERB SOUNDS STRANGE, OR THE THOUGHT IS LEFT HANGING, REFER TO THESE WAYS.

Missing Subjects

- **Fragment:** Was running late that day.

Revised: I was running late that day.

- **Fragment:** Biking and swimming after work on Thursday.

Revised: **Shahid went** biking and swimming after work on Thursday.

Missing Verbs

- **Fragment:** The birch trees with their rattling yellow leaves.

Revised: The birch trees with their rattling yellow leaves **swayed in the wind**.

Unfinished Thoughts

- **Fragment:** Because tuition increased again this semester.

Revised: Because tuition increased again this semester, **Arshad got a second job as a Student Assistant.**



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Identify and revise the sentences as fragments or run-ons.

- The patient came early the clinic was still closed.

- Because the anesthesia did not work properly.

- The filling fell out it was not sealed correctly.

- When the patient arrived late for the appointment.

- The X-ray was blurry the technician repeated the scan.



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Identify and revise the sentences as fragments or run-ons.

- Since the crown was damaged during chewing. F
- The dentist completed the extraction it healed quickly. R
- Because the instruments were not sterilized properly. F
- The gum was swollen the patient complained of pain. R
- After the braces were removed. F

WORKSHEET

KEY: DENTAL CASE SCENARIO: THE CASE OF THE HURRIED NOTES

■ Subjective Findings:

The patient reported a constant, throbbing pain that began two days ago. The pain worsens when he lies down or drinks something cold, **and** he rated the pain as an 8 out of 10. **He reported** no significant relief from over-the-counter painkillers, **and he presented today** because the pain has become unbearable.

- *Run-On: two independent clauses fused.*
- *Fragment: a dependent clause standing alone.*



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KEY: DENTAL CASE SCENARIO: THE CASE OF THE HURRIED NOTES

■ Objective Findings:

Clinical examination revealed a large, deep carious lesion on tooth #46 (lower right first molar). There was visible cavitation and food impaction. The tooth was tender to percussion **and** sensitive to palpation. The periodontal probing depths were within normal limits; **however**, there was a slight buccal sinus tract present.

- *Fragment: "And sensitive to palpation" has no subject.*
- *Run-On: two independent clauses incorrectly joined with a comma.*



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KEY: DENTAL CASE SCENARIO: THE CASE OF THE HURRIED NOTES

■ Radiographic Findings:

A periapical radiograph was taken, **which showed** the radiolucency extending to the pulp chamber of tooth #46. There is also a periapical radiolucency visible, **which suggests** a chronic apical abscess.

- *Fragment: "Showing..." is a dependent clause. Corrected by turning it into a relative clause.*
- *Fragment: "Suggesting..." is a dependent clause. Corrected by turning it into a relative clause.*



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KEY: DENTAL CASE SCENARIO: THE CASE OF THE HURRIED NOTES

■ Assessment & Plan:

Diagnosis is symptomatic irreversible pulpitis with chronic apical periodontitis for tooth #46. The treatment options were explained to the patient, including non-surgical root canal treatment or extraction. The patient opted for root canal therapy. We prescribed a course of amoxicillin to manage the infection **and** scheduled the procedure for the following week. The patient was advised to take analgesics as needed, **and** he was also given post-operative instructions.

- *Fragment: "And scheduled..." has no subject.*
- *Run-On: two independent clauses fused.*



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PRACTICE 2

- _____ 1. Rare earths are a collection of seventeen elements, ^{. Manufacturers} manufacturers need these elements to produce numerous items. For example, color televisions, lasers, radar systems, military hardware, and computers contain rare earth elements.
2. Rare earth metals are not really rare [;] they are found mostly in certain countries [;] ^{therefore,} around the world. China produces 97 percent of world supplies ^{it easily} surpasses American production. Many nations are becoming concerned about ^{because} the Chinese monopoly of rare earth production; ^{the metals are very necessary} in the manufacturing of new technological products.



PRACTICE 2

- _____ 3. Recently, China has used its rare earth reserves as a political weapon. Japan and China had a diplomatic row in 2010 over disputed ownership of islands in the East China Sea. The Japanese arrested Chinese fishers near the islands ^{, and} China withheld exports of rare earths to Japan. The elements are crucial for the Japanese electronics industry.
4. American bureaucrats are worried that China may withhold exports to the ^{. The} United States during a dispute ^{the scarcity would lead to a disaster for the} manufacturing sector. Politicians feel that dependence on the Chinese is ^{and} troublesome, ^{it may lead to both economic and national security risks.} The government is looking for other sources of rare earths [;] ^{it is also looking at ways} to mine American deposits of the elements in an environmentally safe way.



PRACTICE 3

1. In 1984, a terrible chemical accident happened. C In Bhopal, India. F Union Carbide was one of the largest chemical companies in the United States. C It built a plant in downtown Bhopal in 1969. C In 1984, a holding tank leaked toxic gas. C Which killed thousands of people. F Other victims suffered from health problems. C Such as blindness and respiratory diseases. F The company refused to take any responsibility for the accident. C Even though the Indian government accused it of negligence. F The government sued the firm for monetary compensation. C For the victims. F It wanted billions of dollars. C However, the victims' families only received about \$2,000. C



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PRACTICE 3

2. In 1986, another human and environmental tragedy occurred. C The Chernobyl nuclear power plant. F It was built in Ukraine. C The reactor exploded and released radioactivity into the atmosphere. C It was the largest radioactive fallout in history. C For example, greater than the atom bombing of Hiroshima. F The accident was such a terrible catastrophe. C That people in the vicinity had to be evacuated. F The radioactive particles affected people's health. C The accident also harmed the environment. C In particular, contaminated ground water, soil, rivers, and lakes. F Presently, the damaged reactor is covered. C In concrete. F



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THANK YOU

References:

Writing Academic English by Alice Oshima and Ann Hogue, Chapters 10 & 11.